

Uepaki — Seller Conversion Playbook

Converting an interested professional into an active — and eventually transacting — Uepaki professional

Prepared for Sahil Mittal, Founder

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Companion deliverables:

File	Content
UEPAKI_SELLER_OBJECTION_PLAYBOOK.docx	17 objections: short and long responses, what not to say, CTA, basis
UEPAKI_FOUNDING_PROFESSIONAL_PROGRAMME.docx	Programme design for founder decision
UEPAKI_PROFESSIONAL_ONBOARDING_PLAYBOOK.docx	Checklists, 48/72-hour sequence, escalation
UEPAKI_SELLER_ACTIVATION_CHECKLIST.xlsx	Per-professional tracker with automatic activation flag and cohort KPIs
UEPAKI_SELLER_REFERRAL_FRAMEWORK.md	Compliant peer-introduction framework
UEPAKI_CONVERSION_KPI_FRAMEWORK.md	Conversion definitions and diagnostic test thresholds
UEPAKI_WHO_HAS_JOINED_RESPONSE_FRAMEWORK.md	Truthful social-proof mechanism

1. Summary

The acquisition system and the outreach engine produce **interested professionals**. This playbook is about what happens next. On the library's own evidence, the hardest part of conversion is unlikely to be persuasion. It is more likely to be:

- **friction in the seller journey**: a payment at registration; KYC and store approval; a verified-GSTIN requirement on orders; gate mismatches between policy and code;
- **the gap between “interested” and “has something approved to read”**: the seller terms and the founding-programme terms are not yet final.

So the conversion system does four things:

1. **Answers objections truthfully, from records**. The 17-objection playbook cites a founder decision or evidence record for every answer, says plainly what is decided but not yet implemented, and never answers with a promise of customers, visibility, ranking or income.
2. **Carries each professional through onboarding as a service**. A readiness check before registration catches the dead ends (GST status, listing type by category). A 48/72-hour sequence and assisted set-up follow, with an escalation path for every product defect.

3. **Turns early commitment into a serious founding programme.** It is built only on what the founder decided (500 seats, a lifetime 2-point commission reduction, promotion on four social channels, no visibility advantage) plus operational commitments the team can deliver. Every open term is marked.
4. **Makes “who has joined?” answerable without inventing anything.** Live, defined counts of activated professionals, consented names, and a published ladder of what may be said at each stage.

North star: activated professionals. **Ultimate measure:** transacting professionals.

2. The conversion journey

#	Stage	Enters when	Owner	Evidence and constraints that shape this stage	Drop-off risk
1	Prospect	In the master database	Research	3,584 records; 1,538 contact-ready; 0 opted in	—
2	Contact	A 1:1 message is sent through a verified route	Outreach lead	Contactable ≠ consent; no cold WhatsApp	Medium
3	Response	Any human reply	Outreach lead	Wedding-season availability (assumption to test)	High (normal for cold outreach)
4	Interest	Positive intent	Outreach lead	“Who has joined?”, “Will I get customers?”	Medium
5	Information	The information note is sent, or a call is held	Founder / onboarding lead	Seller Policy v1.4 not approved for acceptance; founding terms not final (FP-OUT, FP-QUAL)	High
6	Registration	Registration completed	Onboarding lead	Online payment of ₹1 + GST via Razorpay even on the “free” path (EV-01 a); app/web mismatch (SUB-06); Refer & Earn redirect	High
7	KYC	KYC submitted and verified	Onboarding lead	Mandatory checks OPEN (Q-KYC, CA-KYC); a “three-pillar KYC” exists in code, but its pillars are not recorded	High
8	Approval	Account and store approved	Admin / onboarding lead	An approved store is required for product creation (EV-01 b); turnaround unknown	Medium
9	Profile completion	Profile standard met	Onboarding lead	Effort; images to hand	Medium
10	First listing/service	At least one listing live	Onboarding lead	Products only in 3 categories; create_listing gated in code contrary to policy (U-3); GST at listing unconfirmed; service/booking features at launch unverified (EV-09); bookings are a paid-plan feature (23 C3)	High
11	Activation	8 + 9 + 10 + payout details + good standing	Founder sign-off	Withdraw is premium in code (U-1 open)	Medium
12	First enquiry/order/booking	First genuine customer interaction	Founder	Orders blocked without a verified, active GSTIN (EV-01 c); launch timing; demand cannot be promised	High
13	Repeat activity	Second transaction, or ongoing activity	Founder / support	Fulfilment (self-ship disabled, E12; 48-hour dispatch with consequence OPEN); payouts (holds OPEN, Q-HOLD)	Medium

The pre-launch gap. Professionals activated before launch have nothing to transact on until customers arrive. Without regular, honest contact (monthly founding updates, feedback sessions), they go cold, and stage 12 starts from a disengaged base. Plan for it.

3. The biggest likely drop-off points

Ranked by expected impact. “Evidence” means a library record; “reasoning” means an inference to be tested.

Rank	Drop-off	Why (evidence / reasoning)	Mitigation
1	Activation → first order, for sellers without a verified GSTIN	Code blocks order placement unless the seller's GSTIN is verified and active (EV-01 c). Many independent artists, makeup artists and small makers may not be GST-registered (reasoning — unmeasured). They could be fully activated yet unable to receive orders	Founder + CA decision on the policy for unregistered sellers (CA-KYC, Q-KYC). Meanwhile, ask about GST in the readiness check and tell professionals honestly. No tax advice
2	Interest → information/registration: nothing final to read	Seller Policy v1.4 is an internal draft, not approved for seller acceptance; founding terms OPEN; plan prices pending (EV-03)	Send the interim information note (§4). Prioritise FP-OUT and legal review of the Seller Policy. Never ask anyone to accept terms that aren't approved
3	Registration payment step	₹1 + GST via Razorpay is mandatory (EV-01 a). A surprise if anyone said "free"; payment failures; app/web inconsistency	Disclose in advance (SUB-01); register together on the call; monitor payment failures; one path (web) until aligned
4	KYC and store approval	Checks undefined in the library; store approval required; turnaround unknown	Readiness check; an admin turnaround target (test: 3 business days); clear rejection reasons
5	First listing blocked or confusing	Category restriction; the create_listing gate; service/booking configuration; GST at listing	Category-specific first-listing plans; engineering alignment of gates (code handoff rows 1, 5, 9, 10); confirm the live flow before Wave 0
6	Payout set-up for free sellers	Withdraw is premium in code (U-1) — this contradicts the free-core policy in substance	Founder decision U-1 before any seller is activated on the free core
7	"Who has joined?" at the interest stage	The universal pre-launch objection	Who-has-joined framework; ecosystem pods; consented names
8	Pre-launch disengagement	A gap of weeks between activation and customers	Monthly founding updates; feedback sessions; honest progress reports

4. Interim information note (until seller terms are approved)

Send this when a professional asks for details, adapted per segment. Every line is a decided fact or a clearly marked open item. **The founder approves the final wording once**, before first use.

Uepaki — a short note for [PROFESSION]s

What Uepaki is. A marketplace where customers can discover and buy products and connect with creative professionals for services, bookings and projects. Uepaki is preparing to launch in India.

Where we are. Before launch, we're personally inviting a first group of professionals, city by city, across fashion, beauty, photography, design, art and content.

For [PROFESSION]s. [THREE SEGMENT VALUE POINTS FROM THE MESSAGE LIBRARY]

Registering. Registration is on the Uepaki website and carries a charge of ₹1 + GST, paid online. We'll help you through it on a short call if you like.

What's free and what's paid. Under Uepaki's policy, you don't need a subscription to register, list products or accept ordinary orders. Paid plans add specific extra features: custom requests, bookings and milestone payments, customer chat, analytics, and team, bundle and design-project tools. A paid plan does not buy higher organic ranking, and there is no paid placement. Plan prices are being confirmed.

Commission and fees. Uepaki charges a commission on sales, and a payment-gateway charge applies to sellers on transactions paid online. Both will be set out in the seller terms.

Shipping (products). Product orders ship through Uepaki's logistics arrangement at launch rather than self-shipping. Details are being confirmed.

Founding group. [FP-OUT SENTENCE]

Not final yet — and we'll send each in writing before you're asked to accept anything:

- the full seller terms;
- plan prices;
- which service and booking features are switched on at launch;
- the rules on communicating with customers outside Uepaki;
- the launch date.

What we don't promise. Customers, enquiries, bookings, sales or rankings. We'd rather say that plainly.

Questions. [NAME, ROLE, CONTACT]

5. Objection playbook (summary)

Full text: UEPAKI_SELLER_OBJECTION_PLAYBOOK.docx.

Objection	Core of the answer	CTA
Who else is on Uepaki?	Live count of activated professionals plus consented names; honest about the stage; pods	15-minute call
Why should I join?	Depends on fit; segment value; no customer promise	Information note or call
I already have Instagram	Different job; not a replacement	Show a profile built from existing work
I already have clients	Additional channel; "no" is a fair answer	Come back closer to launch
I use Myntra/AJIO/etc.	Additional channel; never compare or name	Information note
Will I get customers?	Can't promise; Uepaki's job is to bring customers; we help with listings	Set up the profile together
Is there a joining fee?	₹1 + GST registration; no subscription needed for the core under policy	Registration guide
What commission?	In the written terms; no figure from memory	Terms when final
What does subscription do?	Specific paid extras; same in every tier; doesn't buy organic ranking; prices pending	Plan details when confirmed
Is organic reach paid?	Policy: no paid placement; subscription doesn't buy organic ranking; founding gives no visibility advantage	Ranking explanation when published
How does ranking work?	Policy yes, mechanics not yet (published only once verified)	Same
Why join before launch?	Set up properly; first group in the city; a say; founding programme; full information first	Set-up call
I'll wait until launch	Reasonable; come back at launch or set up early with no obligation	Launch message or call
I'll wait until you have customers	Fair; we'll return with real numbers	Post-launch follow-up
Send me details	Interim information note	One follow-up
I don't have time	We set it up together, or later	Call or date
I don't need another platform	Respect it; suppress if no	None

6. Founding Professional Programme (summary)

Full design: UEPAKI_FOUNDING_PROFESSIONAL_PROGRAMME.docx.

Element	Position
Cohort	First 500 sellers — DECIDED (S07)
Qualifying rule	PROPOSED: registration completed + approved + first live listing, in order of listing date (FP-QUAL)
Eligibility	Open to any professional in India, in any category, who qualifies while seats remain (E10). Outreach decides whom Uepaki invites first, never who may qualify
Benefits — decided	Lifetime 2-percentage-point commission reduction (founder intent; legal, CA and engineering pending). Promotion on four social channels via Creator Advantage (channels and proof of promotion missing)
Benefits — proposed operational	Assisted onboarding; named contact for 90 days after launch; monthly founder feedback sessions; plain-language policy notes; quarterly "you said, we did"
Recognition	"Founding Professional" title in communications (with consent). A profile label only if it has no visibility or ranking effect (FP-REC). No on-platform founding showcase
Visibility	No organic-visibility advantage , explicitly — DECIDED
Referral	No rewards (E4 deferred); unpaid, consent-based introductions only
Duration	Founding status permanent; commission reduction "lifetime" (legal definition OPEN); promotion window OPEN
Exit	Voluntary exit; serious breach via the enforcement process; non-transferable — PROPOSED , for lawyer review

7. The "Who has joined?" solution (summary)

Full framework: UEPAKI_WHO_HAS_JOINED_RESPONSE_FRAMEWORK.md.

- **One register** of verified professionals: status, activation date, and three separate consents (named to peers / social / press).

- **Counting rule:** “on Uepaki” = **activated**. Registrations are reported separately. Exact numbers below 10; round down only; always with an as-of date.
- **Answer ladder:**
 - Stage 0 (fewer than 10 activated): process plus exact count.
 - Stage 1: counts by category plus consented names.
 - Stage 2 (complete pods in 2 or more cities): city × category coverage, names, and offers to introduce.
 - Stage 3 (post-launch): real, consented stories.
- **Publish later:** a live coverage summary (activated by category, cities with complete pods, as-of date), and founding-professional features on social channels (the decided promotion benefit, with consent and rotation).
- **Never:** invented, estimated or rounded-up numbers; registrations shown as active; unconsented names; implied endorsement by associations, stockists or platforms; famous names as bait; on-platform featuring.

8. Onboarding system (summary)

Full playbook: UEPAKI_PROFESSIONAL_ONBOARDING_PLAYBOOK.docx; tracker: UEPAKI_SELLER_ACTIVATION_CHECKLIST.xlsx.

- **Readiness check before registration (R1–R7):**
 - category and first listing type;
 - **GSTIN status**;
 - PAN and bank details;
 - who manages the account;
 - comfort with the ₹1 + GST payment;
 - images and items to hand;
 - consents.
- **Checklists:** onboarding · KYC (CONFIRM items flagged) · profile · portfolio · first listing/service · payout readiness · activation.
- **48/72-hour sequence:**
 - set-up call within 24 hours of interest;
 - registration help at 24 and 48 hours;
 - profile at approval + 24 hours;
 - first listing at approval + 48 hours;
 - unblock call at approval + 72 hours;
 - check-in 7 days after activation.

These are internal test targets, not promises to the professional.
- **Escalation:** L1 onboarding lead (same day) → L2 founder (terms, fees, GST/KYC policy, complaints) → L3 engineering (defects) → legal team (serious cases and appeals, Q-REVIEWER).
- **Known friction F1–F12** to fix or script before Wave 0 (§11).

9. Referral system (summary)

Full framework: UEPAKI_SELLER_REFERRAL_FRAMEWORK.md.

- **Permitted now:** unpaid, consent-based peer introductions only. The referral launch is deferred (E4); existing referral pages are not staying; reward figures are pending (DEC-012); TDS questions are open (CA-AFF-TDS).
- **Who refers:** activated, satisfied hub professionals — photographers, makeup studios/academies, bridal labels, studios, makers, emcees.
- **When:** a soft ask at activation; after positive feedback; after the first genuine transaction. Never at registration, never after a complaint, at most three asks in total.
- **How:** scripts; the introducer’s consent to be named; contact the peer only through public business routes.
- **Offer:** thanks; news when the peer joins (with the peer’s consent). **Never:** money, credits, points, commission reductions, Creator Advantage points, promotion slots, ranking, leaderboards, or the ₹50/₹100 values in code.

10. Conversion KPIs (summary)

Full framework: UEPAKI_CONVERSION_KPI_FRAMEWORK.md. **All thresholds are diagnostic test thresholds, not Uepaki benchmarks.**

Conversion	Window	Investigate if below (test)	Healthy signal (test)
Interested → Registration completed	14 days	30%	≥ 50%
Registration → Approval	7 days	70%, or median > 3 business days	≥ 85% within 3 business days
Approval → Profile completion	7 days	60%	≥ 80%
Profile → First listing	7 days	70%	≥ 90%
First listing → Activation	7 days	80%	≥ 95%
Activation → Transaction	30 days after launch	Measure first; set from data	—
Transaction → Repeat	60 days	Measure first	—
Interested → Activated (overall)	30 days	25%	≥ 40%

Read on weekly cohorts of at least 10. Cut by category, city, tier, wave, channel and experiment cell. Guardrails: anyone told “free”; complaints or opt-outs above 2%; founding seats held by non-activated sellers above 10%; any category above 30% of activated professionals.

11. Decisions and fixes needed before Wave 0

#	Item	Type	Why it blocks conversion
1	FP-OUT — founding wording for 1:1 use	Founder	Every information step
2	FP-QUAL — qualifying rule	Founder	Founding seats must go to activated professionals
3	Approve the interim information note (§4)	Founder	The information stage
4	Policy for sellers without a GSTIN (orders blocked in code)	Founder + CA (CA-KYC)	Possible largest drop-off for independents
5	U-1 — can free sellers withdraw earnings?	Founder	Activation and payout
6	U-3 / U-5 — listing and service gates aligned with the free-core policy	Founder + engineering	First listing
7	Remove the Refer & Earn redirect at sign-up	Engineering	Registration; referral compliance
8	Web/app registration alignment (SUB-06), or use web only	Engineering / operations	Registration
9	Confirm live KYC checks and the approval flow; set an admin turnaround target	Engineering / operations	KYC → approval
10	EV-09 — which service and booking features are on at launch	Engineering + founder	Service professionals' first listing
11	Seller Policy legal review (package prepared, not sent)	Founder → lawyer	Terms acceptance
12	NAME-CONSENT field in onboarding; the Verified Professional Register	Operations	“Who has joined?”
13	Q-LEGAL-OUT — legal review of outreach and consent method	Lawyer	Waves 1+

12. Final audit

Check	Result
No fabricated social proof	Pass. Live, defined counts of activated professionals; names only with recorded consent; no counters; no “in talks” names; no implied endorsement
No guaranteed leads	Pass. Every customer/lead question is answered “I can't promise”; prohibited in all scripts
No guaranteed sales	Pass. As above; no income or outcome language anywhere
No paid ranking promises	Pass. Policy stated as decided (B1, FD-03); founding gives no visibility advantage (S07); no ranking mechanics described (B4/EV-08, FD-04); recognition kept out of ranking; no on-platform showcase
No contradiction with founder decisions	Pass. ₹1 + GST disclosed (SUB-01); open to all sellers (E10); referral deferred (E4); early-bird kept separate (FP-1); founding core terms used as recorded (S07), with open items marked; serious cases go to the legal team, not described as independent (Q-REVIEWER); India only (E9); launch date not stated (EB-1)
No unsupported Uepaki capabilities	Pass. Features described only as decided policy, with implementation status; launch modules marked unverified (EV-09); every operational benefit labelled as a team commitment needing founder confirmation; KYC items marked CONFIRM
Not done	Nobody was contacted; no founder decision was changed; no product behaviour was verified in production (all code findings come from library records)